

- * The term inherit as used here does not fit the traditional definition, which relates to receiving cash or its equivalents as a right or title descendible by law from an ancestor at his or her death. Nor does a spouse fit the strict definition of an ancestor. In reality, almost all the wealth of millionaire couples is held jointly; this is the main reason it is nearly impossible to estimate the number of individual millionaires and why we substitute the number of millionaire households. Nevertheless, it is a bit misleading to use the term inheritance when discussing the interspousal transfer of wealth. While both spouses are alive, what is his is hers and what is hers is his.